Module 14: Macroevolution - Learning Questions

1. What does the biological species concept emphasize?
2. Why does reproductive isolation matter for speciation?
3. What is a prezygotic barrier?
4. What is a postzygotic barrier?
5. How do allopatric and sympatric speciation differ?
6. Why is polyploidy important in some plant speciation?
7. How does reduced gene flow permit divergence?
8. What does a phylogeny represent?
9. How does macroevolution build from microevolution?
10. What evidence would support a speciation claim?
11. Two populations look different but produce viable, fertile offspring when brought together. What observations of mating and gene flow in nature would you need before judging reproductive isolation?
12. An isolated polyploid plant cannot mate with nearby diploids. Why must it also reproduce successfully for a lasting new lineage to form?